

Annual Blessing of Children: Foxford Parish Pastoral Council invites parents of **children who were baptised in 2023** to bring your child to **St. Michael's Church on Sunday 11th October at 3 pm** for a short **Prayer Service and Blessing**. Other family members will also be very welcome. Refreshments will be served afterwards in the **Admiral Brown Hall**. Looking forward to seeing you!

Invitation to Get Involved: At the recent meeting of the Parish Pastoral Council, the desire for greater lay participation in our weekend parish Masses was discussed. We would love to see more families and parishioners getting involved. There are a number of ways you can participate, including: **reading at Mass, Leading the Prayers of the Faithful or bringing up the gifts of bread and wine**. This can be especially meaningful at Month's Mind or Anniversary Masses, when family members may wish to take part in remembering and praying for a loved one. We warmly invite you to consider getting involved. It would be wonderful to see more people taking an active part in our weekend Masses. If you would like to participate, please contact Fr. Padraig or any member of the Parish Pastoral Council.

Jubilee of Marriages : Couples celebrating their **Silver, Ruby, Golden, Diamond, Platinum or other wedding anniversaries** are invited to attend one of two Jubilee Masses, along with their families and friends. **Sunday 4th October at 2.30pm in Ballaghaderreen Cathedral F45 FW27 or Sunday 11th October at 2.30pm in Kiltoom Church N37 NY36**. Bishop Kevin will celebrate both Masses and light refreshments will be served afterwards for all in attendance. As each couple celebrating an Anniversary will receive a certificate from Bishop Kevin, they are asked to register their details by clicking on the button on the Achonry/Elphin website. achonrydiocese.org

Adoration of the Blessed Sacrament in St. Michael's church on Tuesdays after 10 am Mass until 11.30 am.

Tax Rebate Scheme: This is a great source of revenue to our parish each year. A very sincere **word of thanks** to all who use the system. Any taxpayer who contributes **€250** or more to the parish collections in **the year** is eligible. The Forms for signing up are available at the church porches. All, **regulars and newcomers**, are invited to take a form and sign it and drop it in, in the next few weeks.

Áirc Damhsa will be returning to Foxford Sports Centre this September: **Set Dancing Classes**, Mondays, starting 28th September, contact: 087 446 9624. Children's Sean Nós Dance Classes Fridays, starting 25th September **Contact: 087 703 4584**

We Can Quit – Stop Smoking Group Ballina – The HSE under the Sláintecare Healthy Communities initiative are offering a **FREE** stop smoking programme in The Newman Institute Ballina starting on October 7th for 7 weeks from 7-8.30pm. We Can Quit is a **FREE** Group Based Stop Smoking Programme. **FREE** nicotine replacement medication, group support and one to one Support will be offered to all participants. For more information or to book a place please contact Brenda Mc Nicholas on 087 4484711 or email brenda.mcnicholas1@hse.ie

Supporting Children (8 - 11 years) grow in faith and friendship: New and emerging Faith & Fun Clubs in the Achonry and Elphin Dioceses now enrolling for 2026/2027 school year. For more info please visit: <https://achonryelphin.ie/fafc/>

Bereavement Support Group: A Bereavement Support Group meets at the **Family Centre, Knock Shrine** each **Wednesday morning at 11am**. Trained facilitators conduct the meetings, which provide guidance and support to all who find loss difficult. All are welcome. Further information from Monica Morley on 094-9375320.

"Remembrance by Candlelight" St. Michael's Church Foxford, Friday 20th November @ 7pm. Join Opera singer **Sean Ruane**, alongside the **Cill Aodáin Choral Society, Maria Lynn, John Mc Hugh, The Doherty's and The Doocey's** for a candlelight evening of amazing performances. The proceeds from this year's event are in aid of Hugh's House (in memory of baby Cian McHale), along with the Foxford Enhancement Group, Foxford Christmas Lights and St. Michael's Church, Foxford. Advance booking is advisable as we cannot guarantee tickets will be available on the night. Tickets €20 From **Sarah 087 7965520 / Irene 087 2795242**.

Moy Davitts 50/50 draw: Congratulations to **Martin Jordan**, Bohola, who won a jackpot of **€639** in the Moy Davitts 50/50 draw last Saturday. A huge thank you to everyone who supported last week's draw, it is greatly appreciated. Tickets are available in the usual retail outlets and by playing on the club app (Moy Davitts GAA)

Temporary Closure: Please note that the **Fr Peyton Centre** will be closed from **Monday 28th September to Tuesday 6th October** for renovation works. We look forward to welcoming you back from Tuesday 6th October. Thank you for your understanding and continued support.

Would you like to become a member of the **Admiral Brown Branch of Comhaltas** which is based in Foxford? We are now accepting Comhaltas membership for the year ahead. Email ceadmiralbrown@gmail.com. Everyone welcome. Annual Comhaltas Membership Fees: Junior Member (Under 18) - €6 | Adult - €12 | Family - €20

Western Alzheimers urgently need Volunteer Befrienders in your area. Do you have one to two hours per week to spare ? Contact Lucy at **094-9364900 or 087-3694477**.

St. Joseph's Secondary School Reunion for Class 1981 - 1986 will take place on **Sunday 25th October 2026 @ 8.30pm in Moy Hotel, Foxford**. If you are interested in attending please contact : Noeline Ruane 087 2506 762, Majella Molloy 086 1562 760, Majella Ruane 086 8896 961 or Agnes Burke 087 9492 785. Looking forward to seeing as many as possible for a catch up.

Visit of First-Class Relic of St Carlo Acutis to St Nathys Cathedral: We are privileged to welcome a **First-Class Relic of St Carlo Acutis** to St Nathy's Cathedral. The relic will be available for **veneration after the 10am Mass** on Sunday, This is a wonderful opportunity to come together in prayer and to seek the intercession of **St Carlo Acutis, a young saint whose deep love for the Eucharist** continues to inspire people throughout the world. **All are very welcome.**

Is your anger hurting you or others? **Knock Counselling Centre** will run an **Anger Management Programme** on **Fri 9th & Sat 10th October**. Contact: Peter Devers, 094 93 75032 or log onto www.knockshrine.ie/counselling

Looking for a fresh start, new opportunities, or support on your journey towards work? Erris Workability offers a range of supports tailored to you, including **Weekly Workspace, Life Lab, Studio to Stall** and **one-to-one support** to help build confidence, develop skills, explore employment or self-employment, and achieve your goals. The programme is available to people who meet the **eligibility criteria**, and if you're unsure whether you qualify, we're happy to have a chat and talk you through it. **Take the first step and find out what's possible with Erris Workability. Contact Siobhan on 087 499 6605.**

Grow Meetings: A self-help group helping people suffering from stress, anxiety, depression, panic attacks, loneliness etc meet every Tuesday night at **7.30 pm** in **Ballina Community Centre**.

Foxford Meals on Wheels Service: We can provide meals from Monday to Saturday at a cost of €7 per meal. To avail of this service please contact Geraldine on 087 904 0463 or Carmel on 086 606 4670.

Friends of Carmel Gathering at Holy Hill Hermitage F91 CA24 on Saturday 17 October 2026 from 10am to 4pm. To book email friendsofcarmel@gmail.com.

PADRE PIO HEALING MASS Friday, 9 October 7pm, St. Cuan's Church, Ahascragh, Co. Galway.

Additional newsletter notices can be found on <https://foxfordparish.com/newsletter>

If you are a newcomer to the parish/community and would like a box of offertory envelopes please contact Fr Padraig on 087 242 2273

Season of Creation: Each year, from 1 September to 4 October, Christians around the world unite in this special season of prayer and action to care for our common home. It is a time to celebrate God as Creator and to reflect on our shared vocation to protect and cherish all of creation. This year's theme, "Living Water," is inspired by Ezekiel 47:9, 12 - a powerful biblical vision of hope and ecological renewal. Set against the backdrop of exile and loss, the prophet's image of living water flowing from God's sanctuary reveals God's healing presence, bringing new life to rivers, land, biodiversity and communities, while calling us to renewed care for the whole Earth community.

Saint Faustina Weekend on 3rd and 4th October in St Mary's Church, Convoys, Co Donegal F93FX66. Prayer and reflection on Divine Mercy Devotions. All welcome to come to all or part of the weekend. For details, phone 087 9077985 or email raphoeeparish@gmail.com.

"Keyboard/piano lessons for kids aged 4-12 available in the Foxford area. Group lessons and 1-1 lessons available. Beginners welcome. **Contact Amy on 087 6234946"**

Join Our Caring Team! Dementia Support Worker (Care in the Community) Looking for meaningful, flexible work? We're seeking compassionate, honest, reliable people to support individuals living with dementia in their own homes in Co. Mayo Locations: Crossmolina, Ballina, Foxford, Co. Mayo
What You'll Do: •Offer companionship and social connection •Assist with daily living activities •Support meaningful activities •Give primary carers a well-deserved break Flexible hours – work around your schedule! Make a real difference, one visit at a time. Essential :Previous experience in caring Desirable: QQI Level 5 modules in Care Skills & Care of the Older Person Interested? Get in touch today! Email Helen, Client Care Coordinator clientcarecoordinator@westernalzheimers.ie

Parking on Church Grounds: As you may have noticed, two new parking spaces have recently been marked for **wheelchair users only**. We kindly ask that these spaces are kept clear for those who need them. Please also ensure that **clear access is maintained around the church at all times** for cars and, most importantly, for emergency vehicles such as an ambulance. Thank you for your cooperation and consideration.

Lighting Votive Candles: In the interests of safety, please ensure that lighted votive candles remain on the candelabra at all times and are not carried elsewhere in the church. Thank you for your cooperation.

Minister of the Word: Would you like to read at Mass in any of our Churches? Please contact Fr. Costello on (087) 242 2273

The Irish Catholic weekly newspaper. Have you ever thought of getting a copy each week? Many interesting articles each week about our faith etc. Let me know if you wish me to keep a copy for you each week. Also extra copies are available in the church porch each week.

"Free Training: Wondering what to do next? Interested in expanding your skills? National Learning Network Castlebar can help you gain QQI Certification and assist with finding employment. Your Social Welfare payment will remain protected. Ring/Message Sharon on 087 290 9064 to discuss"

St Joseph's Secondary School Lotto €2.50 per line (€5 for 3). Lines can be purchased online at <https://www.ourfundraiser.ie/org/stjosephsfoxford/> All support gratefully accepted. Please contact 094 9256145 for more details.

Fr. Peyton Centre Opening Hours: Opening Hours: Monday to Friday 9.30am to 5.30pm. Tel: 096-45374.

Foxford Brass & Reed Band are celebrating **130 years** in existence this year. A committee has been formed to write a book on the Band's history. We are appealing to the public to help us with this publication by furnishing us (or any band member) with photographs, newspaper articles, your family ties and memories. Every photograph will be copied and returned to you immediately. We appreciate your help.
Please contact Seamus Burke (Chairperson) 086 858 2726

FACT Social Club: We are an independent community-based service here in Foxford, Co Mayo, and we support people living with Dementia or in rural isolation. We are open Mondays to Friday and provide social interaction, activities and much more in a safe and supported environment. If you would like more information on the services we offer, please contact us at: factsocialclub1@gmail.com or telephone **094 925 6662**.

Western Care Home Share Service are looking for people, single/couples/families, to provide short respite breaks to children and adults across County Mayo, in **your** own home. Training and support is provided and a non-taxable allowance is payable for each home share arrangement. If you are interested and/or would like further information about Home Sharing, please contact Ruth Kneafsey, Home share Co-ordinator, 0949029148 or 0876811261.

The Sacrament of Marriage Course - online programme from Maryvale Institute offering theological formation, open to anyone, no prior study required, from September 2026 to April 2027. For more information see <https://www.maryvale.ac.uk/marriage.html>.

Considering a Postgraduate Programme in 2026? For those interested in Parish and Community work, St Patrick's Pontifical University, Maynooth offers Diploma, Higher Diploma and Master's programmes specialising in education and formation in the fields of Theological Studies, Pastoral Ministry, Healthcare Chaplaincy, Youth Ministry, Liturgy, and Liturgical Music. For more visit www.sppu.ie

Fully Escorted Trip to Medjugorje with Marian Pilgrimages-Led by Sharon O Leary. Direct flights from Knock to Mostar. **October 21st- 28th**. Spiritual Director Fr Séan Sheehy (native of Listowel) and accompanied by Fr Nelson Joseph (Louisburgh, Co Mayo) Contact Sharon **086 0523014**.

Foster Care: Have you ever thought about fostering? Change a child's life by becoming a Tusla Foster Carer.
Talk to Tusla Fostering today by freephone **1800 226 771** or visit www.fostering.ie to learn more.

Accord Ballaghaderreen offers a confidential counselling service where couples can explore family relationships. Accord counsellors can help if relationships are under stress. For online counselling please visit www.accord.ie. Alternatively to book a face to face counselling session call Accord Ballaghaderreen on **0879972503**.

The Adoration Chapel at St. Muredach's Cathedral, Ballina is open: Mon - Fri 2 - 8 pm. Sat - Sun 2 - 7pm. All are welcome.
Come to me, all you who labour and are overburdened, and I will give you rest.

Shine Peer Support Groups - Peer support groups for individuals experiencing mental health difficulties and individuals supporting people living with mental health challenges. We offer regular groups in Ballina, Ballinrobe and Castlebar. Email support@shine.ie or call **086 040 7701** for information

Alone Volunteers:Would you be willing to provide companionship to an older person locally? ALONE are seeking volunteers in your area. Full training and support provided. If interested, please apply via the ALONE website at www.alone.ie or for further information please contact us on volunteer@alone.ie or call 0818 222 024. **If you are over 60 and would like to know more about the services ALONE can offer you, please call 0818 222 024.**

Hospital Visits: If you wish the priest to visit relatives or friends in hospital or at home leave a message at the priest's house.

Family Deaths: To put a notice of family deaths or general notices in the newsletter please email foxfordparishnewsletter@gmail.com